

Leave & Time-Off Policy

KnowledgeOS Enterprise Governance Framework & Employee Benefits

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Effective Date: January 1, 2025

Approved By: Chief People Officer

1. POLICY PURPOSE & SCOPE

KnowledgeOS Enterprise recognizes that sustainable performance, innovative thinking, and long-term professional fulfillment depend on healthy work-life balance and personal well-being. This document outlines the company's official policies and operational guidelines governing annual leave, sick leave, casual absences, parental leave, and emergency time off.

This policy applies to all full-time regular, part-time regular, and probationary employees across all global operating locations of KnowledgeOS Enterprise, subject to local labor statutory adjustments where applicable.

2. LEAVE CATEGORIES & ENTITLEMENTS

Leave Category	Annual Entitlement	Accrual Frequency	Encashable / Carryover
Annual Leave (PTO)	20 Working Days	1.67 Days / Month	Max 5 days carryover; Non-encashable
Casual Leave	7 Working Days	Frontloaded annually	No carryover; Non-encashable
Sick & Wellness Leave	10 Working Days	Frontloaded annually	No carryover; Non-encashable
Maternity Leave	26 Consecutive Weeks	Per event	Statutory requirement; Fully Paid
Paternity / Parental Leave	16 Consecutive Weeks	Per event	Fully Paid
Bereavement Leave	3 to 5 Days	Per event	Immediate vs Extended family rules apply
Public Holidays	11 Days / Year	Annual Calendar	Varies by primary hiring jurisdiction

2.1 Annual Leave (Paid Time Off)

Annual Leave is designed for personal relaxation, vacation, and extended personal commitments. Full-time regular employees accrue 20 paid vacation days per calendar year. Employees are encouraged to plan their vacations well in advance to ensure smooth operational continuity.

2.2 Casual Leave

Casual Leave covers short-term unexpected personal emergencies, urgent family commitments, or personal errands that cannot be scheduled outside working hours. Up to 7 days are frontloaded on January 1st each year. Casual leave may not be combined with Annual Leave without prior manager approval.

2.3 Sick & Wellness Leave

KnowledgeOS Enterprise provides 10 days of paid Sick & Wellness Leave annually to support recovery from physical illness, mental health needs, or routine medical procedures. A registered medical practitioner's certificate is required for continuous sick leave exceeding 3 consecutive working days.

2.4 Maternity & Paternity Leave

- **Maternity Leave:** Eligible female employees are entitled to 26 consecutive weeks of fully paid Maternity Leave for the birth or adoption of a child. Up to 8 weeks may be taken prior to the expected delivery date.
- **Paternity & Co-Parent Leave:** Eligible non-birthing parents (including adoptive and surrogacy parents) receive 16 consecutive weeks of fully paid Parental Leave, navigable within the first 12 months following the child's arrival.

2.5 Bereavement Leave

Employees are granted paid leave in the unfortunate event of the death of a family member:

- **5 Working Days:** Immediate family members (spouse, child, parent, sibling).
- **3 Working Days:** Extended family members (grandparent, parent-in-law, legal guardian).

2.6 Public Holidays

KnowledgeOS Enterprise observes 11 standard paid public holidays each year. The official global holiday schedule is published by People Operations annually in Q4 for the upcoming calendar year.

3. LEAVE APPROVAL PROCESS & NOTICE REQUIREMENTS

To ensure project momentum and adequate coverage across operational teams, all leave must be requested and documented through the KnowledgeOS Enterprise HRIS Portal (Workday/Rippling).

Standard Notice Requirements Table

Leave Duration	Minimum Advance Notice Required
1 to 2 Days	24 Hours Notice
3 to 5 Days	1 Week Notice
More than 5 Days	2 Weeks Notice
Maternity / Paternity Leave	30 Days Advance Notice (When foreseeable)

Step-by-Step Approval Workflow

1. **Submit Request:** The employee logs into the HR Portal, selects the leave category, specifies dates, and details handover plans.
2. **Manager Review:** The direct supervisor reviews the request against team bandwidth and project timelines within 48 business hours.
3. **HR Registration:** Upon manager endorsement, the HR System automatically updates balance ledgers and calendars.

4. CARRY FORWARD & FORFEITURE RULES

- **Carry Forward Limit:** A maximum of **5 Annual Leave days** may be rolled over into the next calendar year. Carried-over days must be utilized before March 31st of the new year.
- **Forfeiture:** Unused Casual Leave and Sick Leave balances expire on December 31st each year and cannot be carried forward or paid out.
- **Encashment Policy:** KnowledgeOS Enterprise does not offer cash encashment for accrued annual leave during active employment, as rest and time away are considered non-substitutable for employee well-being. Unused accrued annual leave will be paid out upon separation of employment as mandated by law.

5. FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS (FAQS)

Q1: Can I take Annual Leave during my 90-day probationary period?

A: New hires accrue Annual Leave from Day 1, but usage during probation requires explicit approval from your Department Head and HR. Casual Leave and Sick Leave are fully accessible during probation.

Q2: What happens if a Public Holiday falls during my scheduled Annual Leave?

A: If an official paid Public Holiday coincides with a day of your approved Annual Leave, that specific day will not be deducted from your Annual Leave balance.

Q3: How do I request an extension of Parental Leave?

A: Extensions can be requested as unpaid leave or by utilizing accrued Annual Leave. Requests must be submitted to People Operations at least 3 weeks prior to the conclusion of your standard parental leave period.

Q4: Who should I contact if I experience an emergency and cannot request leave in advance?

A: In the event of an emergency, notify your direct manager and People Operations via Slack or email as soon as reasonably possible, and submit the formal HRIS request upon your return.